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To
Professors Künn and Moatsos,
Maastricht University

May 6, 2026

Sub: Application for PhD Position in Economic History.

Dear Professors Künn and Moatsos,

With great enthusiasm, I am writing to express my strong interest in the PhD position at Maastricht University. As an analytical and collaborative researcher, I am confident that my quantitative research background and problem-solving skills would allow me to contribute meaningfully to your team.

As reflected in my resume, I have built a range of experiences in applied microeconomic research through my work at Queen's University and the Institute for International Economic Studies. I am eager to apply my research, data analysis, and interpersonal skills to produce robust empirical insights for projects in economic history.

As a prospective employee, I can immediately bring the following strengths to your team:

- **Strong analytical skills:** As a Research Assistant, I analyzed datasets and reviewed academic literature for major projects in politics and education. I managed data using SQL and Excel, collected information through Python-based web scraping from diverse online sources, and synthesized both quantitative evidence and qualitative research into concise summary reports. By working efficiently under time constraints, I helped shorten project timelines by two months when rapid delivery was required.
- **Ability to work independently and collaboratively:** In my role as a Data Analyst at the Institute for International Economic Studies, I independently analyzed data from 15,000 Swedish establishments using advanced statistical methods to strengthen research quality. At the same time, I worked closely with research teams to ensure data accuracy and consistency through careful collection and cleaning processes. By developing efficient solutions to data management challenges, I contributed to more reliable analyses, stronger insights, and improved project outcomes.

While my resume provides an overview of my background, I would welcome the opportunity to discuss in greater detail how my experience and motivation can support your team's research goals. I would be honored to contribute to the innovative work being carried out at Maastricht University.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the possibility of speaking with you further about this opportunity.

Sincerely,

Jay Lee